

“You shall know a word by the company it keeps...”

Video extract from

Bruce Forsyth’s *Hot Streak* (US TV, 06. Jan 1986 – 04 Apr 1986, 65 shows in total)

BF: What word is it gonna be? You’ve chosen *horse* – you’ll play the one that is left, gentlemen. Turn around, Terry. Here is your 40 seconds... go!

T: A colt grows up to be...?

* *colt* (zool.) = *foal*
(dt.: *Fohlen*)

P2: Excuse me?

T: A pony grows up to be a ...?

P2: Horse.

BF: Good.

P2: Cowboys ride these...

P3: Horses?

BF: Good.

P3: These are uhm things these have... with uhm four... (nods)... with hooves with hooves... yeah

P4: Horses?

P3: Yeah!

P4: I loved when I was a child to go out on a ranch and I would get on.. on this thing that..

P5: A horse

TV show

Two gender-specific teams of five contestants, one of which was a returning champion, each competed in a **game of word association**. The challengers, or winners of a coin toss in the case of two new teams, played first. In round one, the captain of the team in control **chose one of two words presented by the host**. The other four team members wore **headphones to ensure they could not hear the word**. **Once a word was chosen, the team was given 40 seconds to communicate the word down the line**. The team captain described the word to the second team member, who, after guessing the word, then did the same for the third team member. The process continued down the line **until** the team completed the transition down the line, time ran out, **the team gave an illegal clue, repeated a key word, gestured or said the word (or a form of the word)**. The opposing team played the other word in the round.